



MAJ COMMERCIAL
REAL ESTATE

CLARK COUNTY, WA

MULTIFAMILY & RETAIL PROPERTY INSIGHTS

What Clark County's Most Active Property Owners Are Thinking About Right Now

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BLAKE D. FEDERINKO



Blake Federinko serves as President of the Investment Division at MAJ Commercial Real Estate, focusing on multifamily and retail investment properties throughout Clark County and Southwest Washington.

Throughout his career, Blake has participated in the Clark County market as both an owner and an advisor. He understands the operational realities of holding investment property, the considerations that arise as portfolios mature, and the complexity of repositioning capital through tax-deferred exchanges and passive investment structures.

His work centers on helping owners evaluate where they are, clarify where they want to go, and execute a process that gets them there.

12+

Years in Commercial Real Estate

\$1B+

Total Transaction Volume

“With more than a decade in commercial real estate and over \$1 billion in transaction volume, my focus has always been the same — understand where an owner is, where they want to go, and build a process that gets them there.”
— Blake D. Federinko

Areas of Focus

Multifamily Investments

Apartment communities — from value-add acquisitions to stabilized dispositions and 1031 exchange.

Retail Investment

Neighborhood centers, strip retail, and single-tenant net lease assets throughout Southwest Washington.

1031 Exchange Advisory

Guiding owners through tax-deferred exchanges into replacement properties aligned with long-term goals.

Passive Structures

Transitioning equity into passive structures that reduce management burden while preserving income.

MARKET OVERVIEW

THE CLARK COUNTY LANDSCAPE

POPULATION & GROWTH

±527,000
Current Residents
(2024)

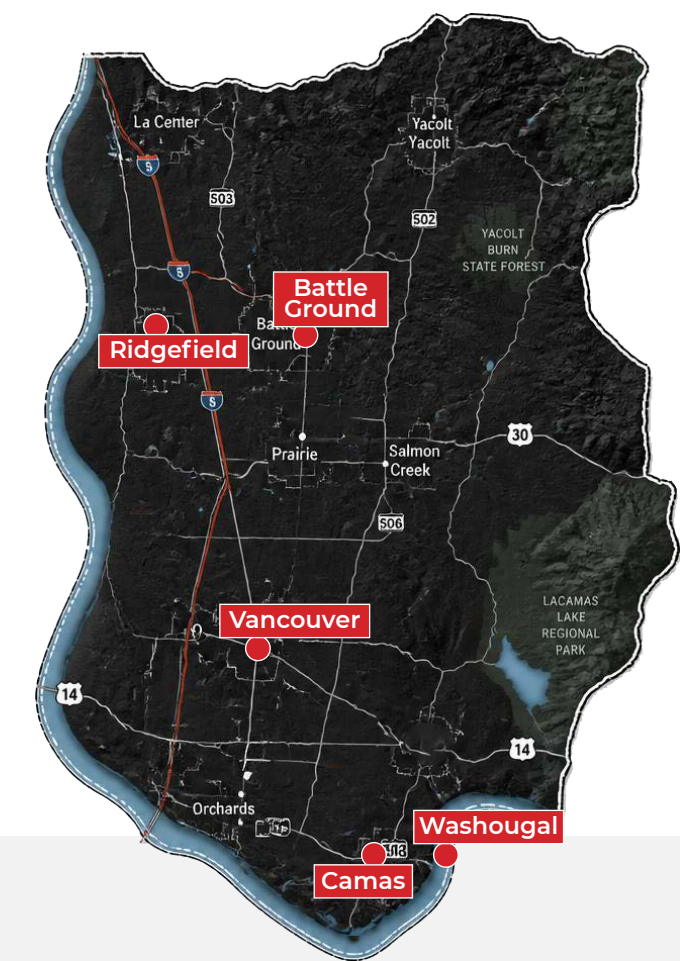
±14,000
Portland Metro
Relocations (2022)

~18%
10-Year Population
Growth

±4,400 / Yr
Annual Population
Increase

Clark County has become one of the most active investment markets in the Pacific Northwest. Sustained population growth, continued migration from the Portland metro, and expanding residential and commercial development have driven demand for both housing and neighborhood-serving retail across the region.

As the county has matured, so has its investment property market, attracting long-term local ownership alongside outside capital and creating a deeper, more competitive transaction environment than existed even a decade ago.



Clark County now represents 21% of the Portland metro area population, up from just 12% in 1970. That shift is the foundation of the investment opportunity that exists here today.

Why Clark County Continues to Attract Investment

Several converging factors have made Clark County a consistent draw for both residents and investment capital over the past two decades:

- Washington remains free of a traditional income tax on wages and salary — a meaningful advantage relative to Oregon that continues to drive Portland-area migration
- Continued infrastructure investment across the I-5 and SR-14 corridors supporting connectivity and commercial development
- An expanding employment base across technology, healthcare, and logistics sectors
- Relative affordability compared to Portland, Seattle, and other Pacific Northwest markets — particularly for housing
- A growing renter population that continues to support multifamily demand across the county

Clark County vs. Portland, OR – Commercial Real Estate

Metric	Clark County	Portland, OR	Advantage
Multifamily Vacancy	6.70%	7.90%	Clark County
Retail Vacancy	3.40%	6.40%	Clark County
5-Yr MF Rent Growth	3.0%	1.60%	Clark County
5-Yr Retail Rent Growth	2.60%	1.80%	Clark County
10-Year Population Growth	~18%	~3%	Clark County

Source: CoStar Group (multifamily & retail data). Portland city population growth per US Census Bureau (2013–2023).

What This Means for Property Owners

For investors who have held assets through this growth cycle, the result has often been significant equity accumulation. Rising valuations, strong rent growth, and sustained occupancy have compounded returns for long-term holders across both multifamily and retail.

That equity accumulation is the backdrop for the ownership decisions many Clark County investors are navigating today, and the focus of the pages that follow.

MULTIFAMILY MARKET

MULTIFAMILY OWNERSHIP

Multifamily housing has been a cornerstone investment throughout Clark County’s growth. Apartment communities have provided both housing for residents and reliable long-term income for owners, and for many investors, multifamily remains a core part of their portfolio strategy.

At the same time, operating multifamily assets requires consistent attention. As properties age, the combination of operational demands and rising costs increasingly shapes how owners think about what they hold.

Operational & Cost Realities



Tenant Turnover
Per-Unit Cost

Unit turnover typically runs \$2,500–\$5,000 per unit for cleaning, repairs, and leasing prep, not including lost rent during the vacancy period between tenants.



Insurance Costs
Rising Rapidly

Multifamily premiums have climbed 50–100%+ since 2020 depending on market, property age, and construction type. Average costs have roughly doubled since pre-pandemic levels, making insurance one of the fastest-growing line items in operating budgets.



Property Taxes
Reassessment Risk

Clark County commercial property taxes generally average 0.85–1.0% of assessed value annually, consistent with Washington State’s constitutional 1% levy limit. As values have appreciated, reassessments can produce significant step-ups in operating costs.



Capital Improvements
Long-Term Investment

Roofs, siding, plumbing, parking, and interior renovations accumulate over time. Major capital programs often require \$5,000–\$15,000 per unit depending on property age and condition.

For many investors, these are simply the realities of ownership. For others, particularly those who have built significant equity and are tired of the day-to-day management, they become the starting point for a different kind of conversation.

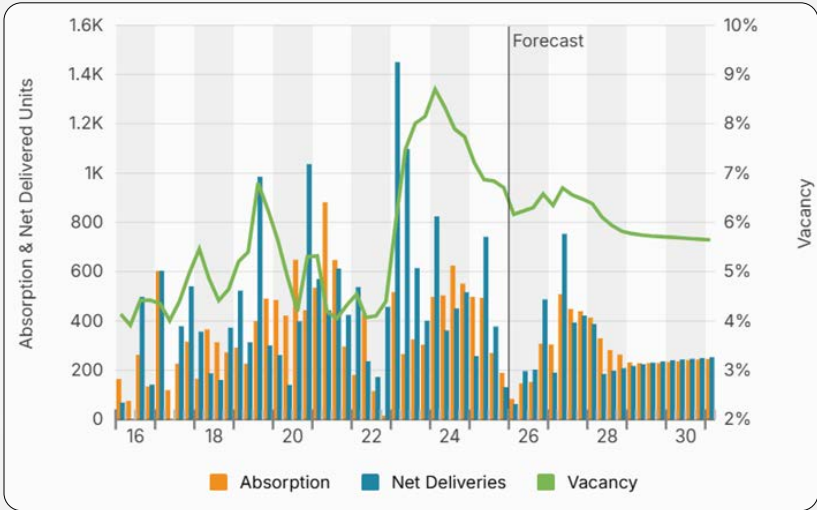
MULTIFAMILY MARKET
SNAPSHOT

CLARK COUNTY
MULTIFAMILY
MARKET

Clark County’s apartment market has expanded alongside the region’s population growth and continued development across Vancouver and surrounding communities. New communities are being delivered to meet demand while existing properties continue to serve long-term residents throughout the county.

Supply & Demand Trends

Absorption, Net Deliveries & Vacancy



Source: CoStar Group.
All market statistics reflect Clark County multifamily market data (20+ units) as reported by CoStar Group. Data is subject to change. Market conditions as of date of publication.

MARKET SNAPSHOT
(20+ UNITS)

±53,360
Total Inventory

\$1,796
Avg Market Rent

1,690
Units Under Construction

6.70%
Vacancy Rate

3.0%
5-Yr Rent Growth

989 Units
12-Mo Net Absorption

RETAIL MARKET

RETAIL OWNERSHIP

Retail properties have been a long-standing component of Clark County's commercial market, serving a growing population across Vancouver and surrounding communities. From neighborhood centers to single-tenant net lease assets, many retail properties have delivered durable income and appreciation for long-term owners.

Retail ownership carries a distinct set of dynamics. Unlike multifamily, where turnover is frequent but predictable, retail leasing is longer-cycle, more capital-intensive, and more directly tied to tenant

Operational & Financial Realities



Vacancy & Downtime
6-12+ Months

Retail spaces can sit vacant for extended periods. Each vacancy cycle typically requires broker commissions, tenant improvement investment, and significant time before a replacement tenant opens.



Tenant Improvements
\$50-\$100+ PSF

New tenants frequently require customized buildouts, with current retail TI costs typically ranging \$50-\$100+ per square foot depending on space condition and tenant requirements. Combined with leasing commissions, typically 4-6% of total lease value, the cost of securing a new tenant adds up quickly.



Tenant Risk
Business-Dependent

Retail cash flow is directly tied to tenant performance. Local tenants in particular can be sensitive to economic shifts, creating re-leasing cycles that require both time and reinvestment.



Capital Upkeep
Ongoing Investment

Parking lots, roofs, facades, and site improvements require regular reinvestment to keep properties competitive. The longer a property is held, the more these costs accumulate.

For owners with older centers, increasing vacancy, or simply a changing sense of how actively they want to be involved, these dynamics often prompt a closer look at what the portfolio should look like going forward.

RETAIL MARKET

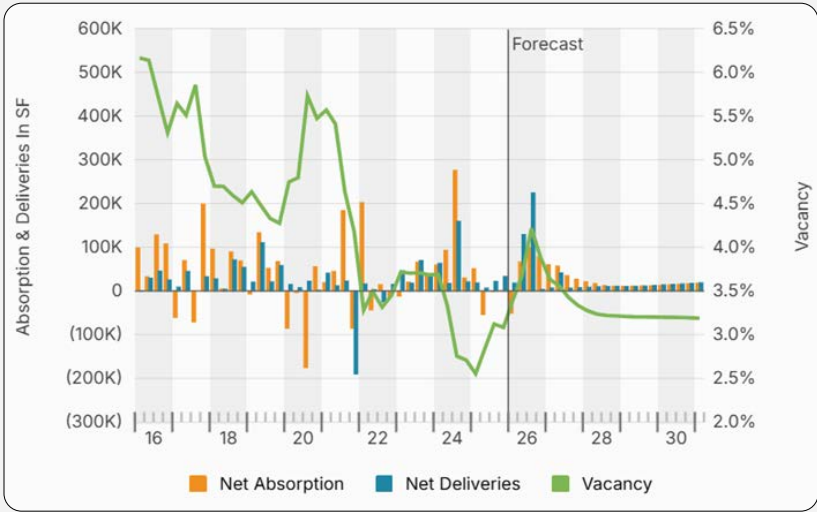
SNAPSHOT

CLARK COUNTY
RETAIL MARKET

Clark County's retail market serves a mix of national, regional, and local tenants supporting everyday consumer demand across Vancouver and surrounding communities. The market has continued to develop alongside population growth, with new construction activity concentrated in high-growth corridors.

Supply & Demand Trends

Net Absorption, Net Deliveries & Vacancy



Source: CoStar Group.
All market statistics reflect Clark County retail market data as reported by CoStar Group. Data is subject to change. Market conditions as of date of publication.

MARKET
SNAPSHOT

21.4M SF

Total Retail Inventory

\$26.33 PSF

Avg Asking Rent

-45,200 SF*

12-Mo
Net Absorption

3.20%

Vacancy Rate

2.60%

5-Yr Rent Growth

2.3M SF

Under Construction

* 12-month net absorption reflects near-term softness in leasing velocity. The longer-term trend across Clark County retail has remained broadly positive, supported by sustained population growth and strong tenant demand across neighborhood-serving retail.

THE OWNERSHIP CROSSROADS

For most Clark County property owners, real estate has been central to building long-term wealth. Multifamily and retail assets have delivered income, appreciation, and equity accumulation as the market has grown around them.

At some point, though, the nature of ownership changes. The questions shift from how to grow to how to manage what you have, and eventually, to whether the way you currently own real estate still fits the life you want.

Time & Involvement

Leasing, maintenance, tenant coordination, and oversight require consistent attention across both asset types.

Capital Concentration

Equity built over time is often concentrated in a small number of assets, raising questions about allocation.

Asset Maturity

As properties age, capital demands, re-leasing intensity, and operational complexity all tend to increase.

Income Variability

Cash flow can fluctuate due to turnover, vacancy, and market shifts, particularly in retail-heavy portfolios.

These aren't problems. They're the natural evolution of long-term ownership. But they do create a moment worth paying attention to, and for many owners, that moment is now.

The most productive ownership conversations aren't about selling. They're about understanding what you have, what it's worth today, and whether the way you currently hold it still serves you.

Owners who take the time to evaluate these questions, even when they're not actively planning a change, tend to make better decisions when the moment does arrive.

HOW OWNERS ARE RESPONDING

There is no single answer for what comes next. What matters is that the direction reflects your goals, your timeline, and how actively you want to be involved going forward. Across the Clark County market, four approaches emerge most frequently.

Continue Active Ownership

Some investors remain focused on growing and operating their portfolios, adding properties, managing assets, and reinvesting capital. For owners with the team, appetite, and time horizon to support it, active ownership continues to create value.

Reposition Within Asset Classes

Others sell assets that no longer align with their goals and redeploy into properties better suited to current conditions, location preferences, or operational objectives. A 1031 exchange can allow this repositioning without triggering a significant tax event.

Consolidate or Diversify

As portfolios grow, some owners look to simplify, fewer properties, less complexity, more focus. Others diversify across asset types or geographies to better balance risk and long-term performance.

Shift Toward Passive Ownership

For some investors, the priority becomes reducing day-to-day involvement. Transitioning equity into structures that require little to no management, while still delivering stable, reliable income, becomes the goal.

The right path isn't the same for every owner. But it almost always begins with an honest look at what you have, what you want, and how the two align.

WORKING TOGETHER

NAVIGATING THE NEXT PHASE

Working with owners throughout Clark County, the process of evaluating and repositioning a portfolio tends to follow a consistent progression. The specifics vary, but the structure holds.

1

Evaluate

Review current assets, performance, and overall equity position across your portfolio.

2

Align

Identify how those assets fit with your goals, income, time, tax, or long-term planning.

3

Reposition

Explore opportunities to move capital into structures that better match your objectives.

4

Execute

From marketing and buyer qualification to 1031 coordination and closing, managed start to finish.

Experience across multifamily and retail investments in Clark County, combined with a working understanding of 1031 exchanges and passive investment structures, informs how this process gets executed in practice.

A more intentional approach to ownership often begins with a simple conversation. That conversation is always available.



For many Clark County owners considering a sale, the 1031 exchange is one of the most powerful tools available. It allows investors to defer capital gains tax by reinvesting proceeds from the sale of one property into a like-kind replacement, preserving equity that would otherwise be reduced by a significant tax event.

Used strategically, a 1031 exchange can allow an owner to reposition out of an operationally intensive asset and into a property that better matches their current goals, whether that's a different asset type, a different market, or a more passive investment structure like an NNN leased investment.

Navigating a 1031 successfully requires coordinating the sale timeline, identifying a qualified replacement property within 45 days, and closing within 180 days. Having an advisor who understands both sides of that transaction, the disposition and the replacement, makes the process significantly more manageable.

TRACK RECORD

NOTABLE CLARK COUNTY TRANSACTIONS

Multifamily Transactions



The AVA
35 Units



The Lavonne
75 Units



Haven Hills
168 Units



Autumn Grove
148 Units



The Jax
50 Units

Retail Transactions



7-Eleven with Fuel



Van Mall Court



Black Rock Coffee / Spa



Sherwin-Williams



Popeye's

IN PRACTICE

SUCCESS STORY:

FROM VACANT ASSET TO PASSIVE INCOME

"We had a great experience working with Blake Federinko on the sale of one commercial building and the purchase of another. From start to finish, he was responsive, attentive, and always available when we needed guidance or had questions. His experience really shows – he handled every detail with confidence and efficiency, making sure everything was completed quickly and correctly. He walked us through each step of the process, which made what could have been a complex transaction feel straightforward and manageable. We truly appreciated having him on our side and would absolutely work with him again."

– Derek & Rhonda, Property Owners, Vancouver, WA



Vacant Bank Building – Vancouver, WA



NNN Investment – Vancouver, WA

The Owner's Situation

A Vancouver, WA property owner came to Blake holding a vacant former bank building that had been sitting empty for an extended period. With no tenant in place and carrying costs accumulating, the asset had shifted from an investment to a liability. The owner needed a clear path forward, one that would not only resolve the vacancy problem but position them for a more sustainable ownership structure going forward.

The Challenge

Vacant bank buildings present a unique disposition challenge. The highly specialized layout, drive-through canopy, vault space, teller line configuration, limits the pool of traditional tenants and makes conventional leasing difficult. At the same time, the property's condition and market timing opened a specific opportunity that most owners would have missed without the right guidance.

How We Approached It

Rather than pursuing a traditional lease-up strategy, Blake advised the owner that current market conditions made an owner/user sale the strongest path forward. With SBA financing widely available to qualified buyers, owner/users were actively seeking well-located buildings they could acquire and occupy. Blake positioned the property accordingly, identified the right buyer, and negotiated a transaction that fully resolved the vacancy.

Simultaneously, Blake worked with the owner on the acquisition side, identifying an absolute NNN leased investment as the replacement property. Under an absolute NNN structure, the tenant assumes full responsibility for taxes, insurance, maintenance, and all other property expenses, leaving the owner with a truly passive income stream and no day-to-day management obligations.

The Outcome

The owner successfully exited a 100% vacant, management-intensive asset and reinvested into an absolute NNN leased investment, moving from active problem-solving to completely passive ownership in a single, coordinated transaction.

IN PRACTICE, CONTINUED

SUCCESS STORY:

\$76M MULTIFAMILY SALE JENS POINTE APARTMENTS

I have known Blake Federinko both personally and professionally for the last 12 years. I hold him in the highest regard as it pertains to his commercial real estate brokering services as well as his character, integrity, honesty and hard-working efforts for his clients. I am honored and privileged to consider Blake a close friend as well as trusting him with anyone needing commercial brokering services for selling their properties.

— Darryl H., Investor



Jens Pointe Apartments — 333 NE 136th Ave, Vancouver, WA • 240 Units

The Seller's Situation

The Developer behind Jens Pointe Apartments had delivered a newly constructed 240-unit multifamily community at 333 NE 136th Ave in Vancouver, WA, one of the largest multifamily transactions in Clark County's recent history. As construction progressed toward completion and the community approached stabilization, the Developer recognized an opportunity to capitalize on the asset's value and redeploy capital into future development projects.

How We Approached It

Blake began the buyer identification process while Jens Pointe was still under construction, well before the community reached stabilization. By bringing qualified buyers to the table early, Blake was able to generate competitive interest at a point when most brokers would not yet have begun marketing the asset. This proactive approach gave the seller maximum leverage and ensured a smooth transition from construction completion to closing.

The Outcome

The transaction closed at \$76,000,000, one of the largest multifamily sales in Clark County's history. The Developer successfully monetized the newly constructed community, freeing up capital for future development activity, while the buyer acquired a high-quality, near-stabilized asset in one of the Pacific Northwest's most active growth markets.

TRACK RECORD

WHAT CLIENTS SAY



“It has been a great pleasure to have worked with Blake and the MAJ team on several real estate transactions. Blake takes the time to understand our commercial real estate needs and goals. The care and precision his team applies to every transaction is unmatched. We highly recommend Blake and his team to anyone needing commercial real estate services.”

— Paul H., Investor



“Blake was incredibly responsive — no matter the time of day or night. What truly set him apart was his ability to close. I’ve worked with many brokers who are good at listing properties but struggle to close; Blake’s expertise ensured a smooth and successful transaction every time. His honesty about pricing and market conditions was refreshing and invaluable.”

— Tereasa B., Investor



“Working with Blake on the sale of a Sherwin-Williams property was an absolute pleasure. He demonstrated a high level of professionalism, organization, and attention to detail that set him apart. He navigated every aspect of the transaction with expertise and ensured all my questions were answered promptly and thoroughly.”

— Brad R., Investor



“I have had the pleasure of working with Blake for many years across numerous net leased transactions. His ability to identify high-quality opportunities, navigate complex transactions, and guide clients through 1031 Exchanges has been invaluable. His integrity, transparency, and dedication to client satisfaction are unmatched.”

— Barry P., Investor

ABOUT

MAJ COMMERCIAL REAL ESTATE

MAJ Commercial Real Estate is a full-service commercial brokerage headquartered in Vancouver, Washington, serving owners, investors, and users of commercial space throughout the Pacific Northwest. With decades of broker excellence and deep roots in the Clark County market, MAJ’s team of professionals covers all major property types, retail, multifamily, office, industrial, and land, across sales, leasing, investment advisory, and property management. The firm’s mission is consistent across every assignment: understand the client’s goals and deliver creative, results-driven real estate solutions that support long-term success.

Blake D. Federinko, President, Investment Division

Blake Federinko has spent his entire career at MAJ Commercial Real Estate, where he serves as President of the Investment Division. He holds a Bachelor’s Degree in Finance with a focus on Investments and Market Analysis from Washington State University, and began his academic career at Clark College, where he earned an Associate’s Degree in Business Administration and served on the Board of Directors as a Student Representative.

Over the course of his career, Blake has closed more than \$1 billion in commercial real estate transactions, with a primary focus on Triple Net (NNN) and multifamily investment sales, 1031 exchanges, and Tenants in Common transactions. He has also completed numerous landlord and tenant representation assignments, working with nationally recognized tenants including 7-Eleven, Dutch Bros, Chipotle, Five Guys, MOD Pizza, Sherwin-Williams, and Banfield Pet Hospital, among others.

Beyond his brokerage practice, Blake brings a perspective that few advisors can offer, that of an active property owner. His personal portfolio spans local and national net leased and multifamily investments, giving him firsthand insight into the ownership decisions, operational realities, and capital considerations that his clients navigate.

Blake is an active member of ICSC, the global trade association of the shopping center industry. His work has been recognized with several industry accolades, including MAJ Commercial Real Estate’s Top Producer award in both 2022 and 2025, and the Vancouver Business Journal’s “Best Commercial Real Estate Broker” award in 2019.

Top Producer
MAJ Commercial Real
Estate
2022 & 2025

Best CRE Broker
Vancouver Business
Journal
2019

ICSC Member
Global
Shopping Center
Industry

LET'S TALK ABOUT YOUR PORTFOLIO

Whether you're ready to move or just starting to think about it, the best next step is a conversation. Owners who take the time to understand where they stand almost always make better decisions when the moment arrives.

Wondering what your property is worth today?

Request a complimentary market analysis and portfolio review, no obligation required.

Reach out directly to schedule yours.

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